



“THE TRUE
WORK OF ART IS
BUT A **SHADOW**
OF THE **DIVINE**
PERFECTION.”

Michelangelo Buonarroti, Italian
artist (1475–1564)

MICHELANGELO BUONARROTI (1475–1564) was one of the defining figures of the High Renaissance (see pp.204–05). In 1505, he was invited to Rome by Pope Julius II to begin work on a monumental tomb, an association that would last for 40 years. In 1508, he began work painting a fresco on the Sistine Chapel ceiling, which he completed 4 years later.

The pace of **Portuguese expansion** across the Indian Ocean in the early 16th century was remarkable. From 1505, the Portuguese established themselves in a string of ports along the **East African coast**. The goal was simple and ruthlessly pursued—the domination of the lucrative spice trade with India and East Asia. A key player in this campaign was **Afonso de Albuquerque**, who in 1509 became viceroy of the fledgling Portuguese colony in India. By 1510, he had secured **Goa** as the principal Portuguese base in India; by 1511, he had overseen the foundation of the first Portuguese settlement in Southeast Asia, **Malacca**. He also sponsored the first Portuguese voyage to the Spice Islands, the **Moluccas**, which were reached in 1512 by **Francisco Serrão**, who had sailed in company with **Antonio de Abreu** and **Francisco Rodrigues**.

Sistine ceiling

Commissioned by Pope Julius II, the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel in the Vatican is one of the masterworks of Michelangelo. It depicts scenes from the Old Testament.

- 1505 Portuguese sack **Mombasa**, East Africa
- 1505 Pope Julius II summons Michelangelo to Rome to create his tomb
- 1506 Portuguese seize Red Sea island of **Socotra**
- 1506 Leonardo da Vinci completes *Mona Lisa*
- 1508 Safavids seize **Baghdad**
- 1508 Spanish begin enslavement of natives of **Hispaniola**
- 1508 Michelangelo begins work in Rome on ceiling of Sistine Chapel
- 1508 Pope Julius II creates the anti-Venetian **League of Cambrai**
- April 21, 1509 Accession of **Henry VIII**, England
- February 3, 1509 Portuguese defeat Ottoman fleet at **Battle of Diu**, Indian Ocean
- 1509 Dutch humanist **Desiderius Erasmus** writes satirical tract *In Praise of Folly*
- May 14, 1509 French victory over Venice at **Battle of Agnadetto**, near Milan
- 1509 Spain begins settlement of **Central America** and **Puerto Rico**
- 1510 **Tripoli** captured by Spanish King **Ferdinand**
- 1510 Portuguese seize **Goa**
- 1510 Safavids seize **Herat**, **Bactria**, and **Khiva**
- 1510 Japanese pirate raids against south coast of China begin